

The Mysteries of Khem: Cosmology, the Neteru, and the Living Practice of Heka

A deep journey into the mysteries of Khem, the sacred land of black earth, where magick was the very foundation upon which a civilization was built. From the cosmic architecture of the Egyptian worldview to living ritual and spellwork, this course pairs each layer of theory with a working practice, so that cosmology, the gods, and the craft are learned as one continuous, practical current rather than history read at a distance.

Egypt rewards depth. The more you know, and the more you practise, the more the system opens, layer by layer, like the chambers of the Great Pyramid itself.

PART ONE

Foundation & the Craft

What Heka is, where you sit in three thousand years of practice, and the inner anatomy you are working with.

PART THREE

Words, Symbols & Tools

The sacred objects, numbers, colours and portals a working magician actually uses.

PART FIVE

Working with the Gods

Isis, Anubis, Sekhmet, Osiris and Thoth: who they are, their names of power, and a working for each.

PART TWO

Cosmology You Need to Work

The map of the worlds, the Neteru, and the pantheons, kept to what you actually need to invoke correctly.

PART FOUR

The Core Rites

The rites that open, protect, and close every piece of work you do in this tradition.

FOUNDATION & THE CRAFT
CHAPTER ONE

How to Use This Manual

You are not here to memorise Egyptology. You are here to work: to open a temple, call a god by name, raise power through your own body, and close down cleanly afterwards.

Egypt's magick was practised for over three thousand years, and a spell from the Pyramid Texts and a spell from the Greek Magical Papyri can address the same god quite differently, separated as they are by two and a half thousand years of change. Hold that lightly rather than expecting the whole tradition to behave like one tidy system.

READ THIS BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Every rite in this manual asks you to work with real forces under their real names. Treat the gods as living powers, not literary devices, and prepare, purify, and close down every single time exactly as instructed. This is not decoration around the practice. It is the practice.

Work through the manual in order at least once. The core rites in Part Four, particularly the Ceremony of Purification and the Opening and Closing of the Quarters, are used without being repeated in full every time a later chapter calls for them. Learn them properly before you reach Part Five.

FOUNDATION & THE CRAFT
CHAPTER TWO

Heka: The Power Beneath Everything

The Egyptians had no single word that maps cleanly onto our word “magic.” Their closest equivalent was Heka, and Heka is at once a cosmic force, a god in his own right, and the working technology you are about to learn to use. He is described as older than the gods themselves, present before creation, woven into the fabric of existence rather than added to it afterwards.

“To me belonged the universe before you gods had come into being. You have come afterwards because I am Heka.”

Coffin Texts, Spell 261

“I am one with Atum when he still floated alone in Nun, the waters of chaos, before any of his strength had gone into creating the cosmos. I am Atum at his most inexhaustible, the potence and potential of all that is to be. This is my magic protection, and it is older and greater than all the gods together.”. Book of Coming Forth by Day, New

Kingdom

What this means for you practically is important: there was no lesser, watered-down, folk version of Egyptian magick sitting beneath a purer temple religion. The priest performing the daily rite in the sanctuary and the ordinary person writing a protective spell for a sick child were drawing on exactly the same power, using the same names, the same gestures, and the same understanding that word and image can compel reality to respond. When you work a rite from this manual, however plain your circumstances, you are standing in that same current.

Ma'at and Hu stand alongside Heka as the other two forces you need to understand before you begin working. Ma'at is truth, balance, and right order, the standard every working in this tradition is answerable to. Hu is the creative Word itself: in one telling, Ptah creates the universe from the thoughts of his heart and the words of his mouth; in another, Thoth speaks the world into being. Either way, the principle is the same one you will use every time you vibrate a name of power in this manual: spoken word, correctly aligned with intention, creates and changes reality. It does not simply describe it.

FOUNDATION & THE CRAFT
CHAPTER THREE

A Working Timeline

You do keep it near you while you read. Knowing roughly when a text, spell, or god-form comes from tells you a great deal about its concerns and its language, and stops you flattening three thousand years of living practice into one system.

PERIOD	DATES
Predynastic	c. 5000–3000 BCE
Early Dynastic	c. 3000–2686 BCE
Old Kingdom (the Pyramid Age)	c. 2686–2150 BCE
First Intermediate Period	c. 2150–2030 BCE
Middle Kingdom	c. 2030–1640 BCE
Second Intermediate Period	c. 1640–1540 BCE
New Kingdom	c. 1550–1070 BCE
Third Intermediate Period	c. 1070–713 BCE
Late Period	c. 713–332 BCE
Ptolemaic Period (Greco-Roman rule)	c. 332–30 BCE
Roman Period	c. 30 BCE – 395 CE

Notice the scale of it. The Old Kingdom, when the Pyramid Texts were first carved, is separated from the Ptolemaic Period, when the Greek Magical Papyri were written, by more time than separates us from the fall of Rome. When you meet a name of power or a spell later in this manual, you will sometimes be told which end of that span it comes from. Take that as a clue to how the practice was actually used at the time, not as a mark of authenticity against some single “original” version.

The Magician's Tomb

In the early twentieth century, archaeologists excavating a Thirteenth Dynasty tomb beneath the Ramesseum at Thebes, some 3,600 years old, found something rarer than any royal treasure: the complete working kit of a practising magician, buried with its owner and untouched for over three millennia.



Curved ivory apotropaic wands from the Ramesseum tomb, Thirteenth Dynasty

Inside were wands made from curved hippopotamus tusks, incised with turtles, baboons, long-necked winged lions, and knife- and snake-wielding demons; a bronze wand in the shape of a rearing cobra; small figurines including a lion and several baboons, one of the animals sacred to Thoth; and miniature models of food. Among the figurines were three naked women made without lower legs or feet, and a wooden statuette of a naked woman with a lioness's features, holding a miniature metal snake in each hand, echoing the creatures incised on the ivory wands.

This is worth sitting with before you work a single rite from this manual. Whoever this person was, they were not a priest performing state liturgy in a great temple. They were a working magician with a personal kit built for practical use: protection, healing, the control of hostile forces. That is the tradition this manual is asking you to stand in. The tools change, but the intention behind them, direct, practical, unafraid of the raw and the strange, is exactly what you are being trained toward.

FOUNDATION & THE CRAFT
CHAPTER FIVE

The Eight-Fold Soul

Egyptian magick has no single, simple idea of “the soul.” A person was understood as a working assembly of distinct parts, and you need this map because pathworking, godform assumption, and any work involving the dead all depend on knowing which part of yourself you are actually moving.

Khat

The physical body, the vessel everything else depends on while you are alive.

Ka

Your life force and double, the aspect that could be sustained after death by offerings and could act independently of the body.

Ba

Your personality, the part of you that travels, classically shown as a human-headed bird able to leave the tomb and move between worlds.

Ab

The heart, the seat of conscience and moral awareness. It is the Ab that is weighed against the feather of Ma'at in the Hall of Two Truths.

Sahu

The transfigured spiritual body, the vessel in which the Ba and Ka are reunited after death, formed through correct ritual and correct conduct.

Khaibit

The shadow, an independent aspect of the self capable of accepting offerings and moving as a spirit in its own right.

Akh

The luminous, effective spirit created by the successful union of Ba and Ka, capable of continued action in both the world of the living and the world of the gods.

Ren

Your true name, understood as a real and vulnerable part of you. To know a being's Ren is to have power over it, which is exactly why the names of power in this manual matter so much.

When a working later in this manual asks you to build a godform, step inside it, or travel in pathworking, you are using your own Ba the way the Egyptians understood theirs: as the mobile part of you capable of leaving ordinary consciousness and returning changed. Keep that model in mind rather than a vaguer modern idea of “imagination,” and the practices will make a great deal more sense.

FOUNDATION & THE CRAFT
CHAPTER SIX

Ma'at and the Forty-Two Confessions

Ma'at is truth, balance, and cosmic order, and every serious magical tradition needs some equivalent standard to work against or it curdles into self-serving fantasy. In Egypt this was not abstract. Ma'at stands behind Ra on the solar barge as the source of his power, and in her Hall of Two Truths she oversees the weighing of every heart against her own feather, watched by the Council of Forty-Two Assessors.

The Negative Confessions the deceased makes before that council are usually read as funerary text. Use them instead, right now, while you are alive, as a genuine tool of self-examination before you take up serious practice. Read the list slowly. Do not rush to tick boxes. Sit with the ones that catch.

ASSESSOR	CONFESSION
The Far-Strider, from On	I have not done evil.
The Flame-Grasper, from Kheraha	I have not robbed.
The Long-Nosed One, from Khmun	I have not coveted.
The Shadow-Eater, from the Cave	I have not stolen.
The Savage One, from Rosetjau	I have not killed people.
The Lion-Twins, from Heaven	I have not short-changed people.
The Flint-Eyed One, from Kem	I have not cheated.
The Fiery One, who comes backward	I have not stolen a god's property.
The Bone-Smasher, from Herakleopolis	I have not told lies.
The Flame-Thrower, from Memphis	I have not stolen food.
The Cave-Dweller, from the West	I have not sulked.
The White-Toothed One, from Lakeland	I have not destroyed a god's property.
The Entrail-Eater, from the Slaughter-Place	I have not extorted.
The Wanderer, from Bubastis	I have not spied.
The Fiend, from the Slaughterhouse	I have not committed adultery.
The Examiner, from the Temple of Amsu	I have respected my own body.
The Chief, from Iunu	I have not caused fear.
The Pale One, from On	I have not talked too much.
The Villain, from Andjety	I have fought only to protect.
The Timeless One, from Djedu	I have not caused trouble.

WORKING NOTE

There are forty-two Assessors in the full list; the ones above are the most consistently attested across surviving papyri. Do not treat this as a moral checklist to pass. Treat it as a mirror. Any working in this manual that raises real power will also surface whatever in you is out of balance with Ma'at, and it is far better to meet that honestly now than mid-rite.

COSMOLOGY YOU NEED TO WORK
CHAPTER SEVEN

The Four Worlds

The Egyptians pictured the world as a flat disk floating on the waters of chaos, ringed by marshland, with the waters of chaos also lying above and beyond it. You do not need more geometry than that to work with this cosmology; you need to know who holds each part of it.

Nuit

The Star Goddess. She arches over the world as the vault of heaven, swallowing the sun each evening and giving birth to it again each dawn.

Geb

The Earth God, lying beneath Nuit as solid ground, the ordinary world you stand on.

Shu

God of the air and space between them, holding Nuit and Geb apart so that a world can exist between sky and earth at all.

The Duat

The underworld, lying beneath the disk. Every night the sun passes through it, and after death, part of your own soul will too.

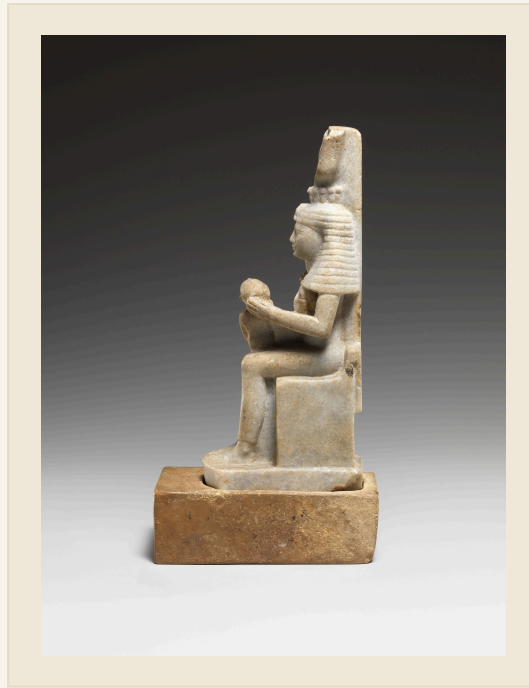
This is the frame every rite in this manual assumes. When you open the quarters, you are working inside Shu's space between Nuit above and Geb below. When a working sends you into the Duat, you are following the same nightly path the sun itself takes, not inventing a new journey.

COSMOLOGY YOU NEED TO WORK
CHAPTER EIGHT

Working with the Neteru

You cannot practise Egyptian magick without working directly with the Neteru, the gods of Egypt. There is no distinct “magical” layer sitting apart from devotional religion here; the same names, images, and gestures serve both.

The Neteru were pictured at enormous scale, often described as some eight cubits high, around four and a half metres, and were shown in human, animal, and theriomorphic (part-human, part-animal) forms depending on which aspect of them was being addressed. Do not read these forms as primitive stand-ins for abstract ideas. A god is not “represented” by a falcon or a lioness the way a company logo represents a business. The animal form is a real aspect of the god's nature, a way that power actually presents itself, and you approach it as such.



Isis nursing the infant Horus, one of the most enduring images in Egyptian religion

You can contact and work with a Neter in more than one way: through their statue or image on a shrine, through vibrating their name of power, through building and stepping into their godform (the technique given in Part Five), or through pathworking, an inner journey to meet them on their own ground. This manual uses all four. None replaces the others; they are different doors onto the same power.

COSMOLOGY YOU NEED TO WORK

CHAPTER NINE

The Three Pantheons

Egypt never settled on one single creation myth, and did not need to. Three great cult centres each offered a full theological system, and rather than choosing between them, Egyptian religious thought let all three stand side by side as complementary lenses on a truth too large for any one account. You need to be able to recognise all three, because which pantheon a god belongs to shapes how you address them correctly.

The Ennead of Heliopolis

Shu and Tefnut, Geb and Nuit, Osiris and Isis, Nephthys and Set, and Horus the Elder: nine gods descending in pairs from the self-created Atum. This is the family tree behind every working with Isis, Osiris, Anubis, and Horus in this manual.

The Memphis Triad

Ptah, Sekhmet, and their son Nefertum. Ptah creates through the thought of his heart and the word of his mouth; Sekhmet is his destructive, protective power; Nefertum, born from the lotus, is renewal and healing completing the family.

The Ogdoad of Hermopolis

Four pairs of primordial forces present before creation: Nu and Naunet (the waters), Heh and Hauhet (infinity), Kek and Kauket (darkness), Qerh and Qehet (the stillness before the first creative word). This is the deepest layer beneath everything else in this manual, the void every working ultimately rises out of.

In practice: when you invoke Isis or Osiris, you are calling on the Ennead. When you invoke Sekhmet in her family role rather than purely as Ra's avenging eye, you are touching the Memphis Triad. And when a rite in this manual asks you to sit in silence before working, the Ogdoad is the state you are returning to, the stillness that precedes the first creative word, Qerh and Qehet's own domain.

COSMOLOGY YOU NEED TO WORK
CHAPTER TEN

The Sons of Horus and the Four Directions

Every quarter-opening in this manual, and there are several, uses the same four guardians in the same four directions. Learn this table before you reach Part Four; it will not be repeated in full each time.

GUARDIAN	FORM	DIRECTION	ELEMENT
Duamutef	Jackal-headed	East	Air
Imsety	Human-headed	South	Fire
Qebehseneuf	Falcon-headed	West	Water
Hapi	Baboon-headed	North	Earth

These four are the Sons of Horus, and in funerary practice each protects one of the canopic jars holding an organ of the deceased. In your own working, they take up the same post at each quarter of your temple, standing beside whichever greater god you call to guard that direction for the rite in hand.



Canopic jars bearing the four heads of the Sons of Horus

WORDS, SYMBOLS & TOOLS

CHAPTER ELEVEN

The Ankh and the Djed

No one knows for certain where the ankh's shape originated, but its meaning is not in doubt: it is life itself, life-sustaining water, air, food, life-force and sexual fecundity all at once. You will see it in almost every temple relief, usually held to the nose of a king by a god, breathing life directly into him.



An ankh amulet, the key of life

Many libation jars were shaped as an ankh, since the power of the sign was thought to bless the water passing through its loop. You can use this directly: pour water or wine through the loop of an ankh, physical or drawn in the air with your hand, as a simple act of blessing before a rite. The ankh is also called the Key of Life, and the word for mirror shared its name, a reminder to look truthfully at yourself before you ask a god to look at you.

The Djed pillar means stability, and probably began as a bundle of corn sheaves or reeds before it came to represent the very backbone of Osiris. Raising a fallen Djed pillar was itself a major rite, performed at Osiris's festivals to renew his stability and, by extension, the stability of Egypt and the king. You will use a version of this raising in Part Five, as an actual technique for raising power through your own body, modelled directly on the Djed.



A relief showing the ceremonial raising of the Djed pillar of Osiris

WORDS, SYMBOLS & TOOLS

CHAPTER TWELVE

The Uraeus, the Sphinx and the Utchat Eye

The Uraeus

A rearing, spitting cobra worn at the brow by royalty, marking rank and active protection against enemies. It embodies the power of the Eye goddesses, the Eye of Ra herself, and can be understood as the awakened serpent-power at the crown of the head.

The sphinx, body of a lion with the head of a king or queen, embodied the ruler's power and their duty to defend Egypt and uphold Ma'at. Female sphinxes were sometimes winged; other sphinxes carried the heads of hawks, rams, or the Set-beast, and stood guard over temples and tombs. A double sphinx called Aker guarded the entrance and exit of the Duat itself, and a winged, serpent-tailed sphinx named Tutu, child of the goddess Neith, was invoked specifically to keep enemies at bay.



The avenue of sphinxes at Luxor Temple

The Utchat, the Eye of Horus, is one of the best-known signs to come out of Egypt, formed from the story of Horus's eye being torn out and later restored in his battle with Set. It stands for wholeness recovered after violence and loss, protection, and clear inner sight, and it is the sign you will use in the practice that follows.

WORDS, SYMBOLS & TOOLS

CHAPTER THIRTEEN

The Eye of Horus Initiation

This is a short attunement rather than a full ceremony, and you can use it on its own before deeper work, or as a daily practice. Its purpose is to open your own inner sight, your Body of Light, to frequencies of energy you do not ordinarily perceive.

1 Prepare

Sit quietly, spine upright. Close your eyes and take several slow breaths until your body settles.

2 See the Eye

Picture the Utchat, the Eye of Horus, directly in front of your own closed eyes, drawn in gold light against the darkness.

3 Let It Approach

Watch the Eye grow slowly larger, moving toward you, until it is the size of your own face.

4 Receive It

Let the Eye settle over your own eyes like a mask of light. Feel it seal there, gold and warm.

5 Open

Say inwardly: "Through the Eye of Horus restored, I see truly." Sit with whatever you perceive, image, feeling, or simple stillness, without forcing an outcome.

6 Close

When you are ready, see the Eye lift away from your face and recede back into the darkness ahead of you until it is gone. Open your physical eyes.

WORKING NOTE

Do not expect dramatic visions every time. The value of this practice builds cumulatively. Use it before pathworking in this manual whenever you want sharper inner sight, and keep a note afterwards of anything you saw, however small.

WORDS, SYMBOLS & TOOLS

CHAPTER FOURTEEN

The Was Sceptre and the Sistrum

The Was sceptre is a straight staff with a forked base and, at its top, the head of a stylised beast, most often the Set-animal. It stands for power and dominion, and is almost always shown carried by a deity, sometimes alongside the ankh and the Djed. You can make or acquire a simple staff to serve the same purpose in your own practice: a Was you hold specifically while working to channel the authority of whichever god you are calling, rather than a general-purpose wand.

The sistrum, *sesheshet* in Egyptian, takes its name from the papyrus plant, and is thought to have begun with priestesses shaking bundles of papyrus flowers in Hathor's honour. There were two forms: the hooped sistrum, with small metal discs or bars set across a loop, and the naos sistrum, which sets twin Hathor-heads inside a small shrine between handle and loop, often decorated with uraeus serpents.



A bronze sistrum, the rattling temple instrument sacred to Hathor and Isis

Use the sistrum exactly as it was used in temple: shaken to mark the opening and closing of a rite, to announce a god's arrival, and through any part of a working where you want to raise or mark a shift in energy. Its sound is itself an offering and a summons, not mere accompaniment.

WORDS, SYMBOLS & TOOLS
CHAPTER FIFTEEN

Sacred Numbers and Colours

NUMBER	MEANING
One	Creation, the original Monad from which all things divide.
Two	Duality as a composite of unity.
Three	Plurality, the first true multiplicity.
Four	Completion, solidity, the four directions and their guardians.
Seven	Perfection, sacred to Osiris.
Eight	The Ogdoad, doubling the power of four.
Nine	The Ennead, three multiplied by itself for major power.
Ten	Time, space, and measurement.
Twelve	Hours, days, and seasons.
Forty-Two	The Assessors, the nomes of Egypt, the Negative Confessions, and the pieces of Osiris's dismembered body.
COLOUR	MEANING
Black	The underworld, resurrection, fertility, the black soil of the Nile.
Blue	The heavens, water, rebirth.
Green	Life, abundance, rebirth, the colour of Osiris's own skin.
Red	Chaos, blood, sacrifice, power, sacred also to Set.
White	Sacredness and purity.
Yellow / Gold	The power of the sun, eternity, constancy, the flesh of the gods.

Use these correspondences directly when you dress an altar or choose a candle for a working: they are not decoration but a working shorthand the Egyptians themselves used to align a space with a particular god or intention before a word was even spoken.

WORDS, SYMBOLS & TOOLS
CHAPTER SIXTEEN

Sacred Incense

Egyptian temple incense was frequently far more than pleasant scent. Some recorded recipes used genuinely psychoactive plants, blue lotus, datura, poppy, in a frankincense base, to induce visions in the priesthood or to support temple sleep, the practice of sleeping in a sanctuary to receive a healing dream. Treat the blends below as working tools, chosen for the state they support, not for pleasant fragrance alone.

BLEND	COMPOSITION	USE
Cleansing Blend	Equal parts cinnamon bark and calamus root.	Clearing a space before ritual, or removing negative influence.
Creativity Blend	Three parts frankincense to one part each myrrh and benzoin.	Creative inspiration and open-heartedness.
Dreaming Blend	One part each calamus, myrrh, opoponax and storax; two parts each cinnamon bark, frankincense and mastic.	Worn as perfume or burned to inspire vivid, prophetic dreaming.
Mental Strength Blend	Equal parts calamus and storax.	Self-realisation and mental clarity; warm the storax gently first so it can be worked.
Temple Blend	Equal parts benzoin, cinnamon, frankincense and myrrh.	General-purpose incense for any rite in this manual.

WORDS, SYMBOLS & TOOLS
CHAPTER SEVENTEEN

The Seven Hermetic Principles

These seven laws sit beneath the whole tradition, Egyptian in root even though the name “Hermetic” is Greek. Every rite in this manual works because it works with these principles rather than against them.

Mentalism

All that is, is mind. The universe itself is mental in nature, which is why a working done with focused attention has real effect.

Polarity

Everything has its pair and opposite, differing only in degree. Male and female, order and chaos, life and death, are one spectrum, not two separate things.

Vibration

Nothing rests; everything vibrates, from the coarsest matter to pure spirit. A name of power works because it is a precise vibration, not an arbitrary sound.

Frequency

Different states, matter, energy, spirit, are the same substance held at different rates of vibration. Raising your own frequency is literally what a working like the Djed Pillar Empowerment does.

Correspondence

As above, so below. The pattern that governs the stars governs the body, the temple, and the working altar in front of you.

Cycles and Rhythm

Everything moves in tides: the sun's daily death and rebirth, the Nile's flood, Osiris's own descent and return. Time your workings with these rhythms rather than against them wherever you can.

Causality

Nothing happens by accident. Every effect has a cause, and every working you perform is itself a cause you are responsible for.

WORDS, SYMBOLS & TOOLS

CHAPTER EIGHTEEN

Magical Portals

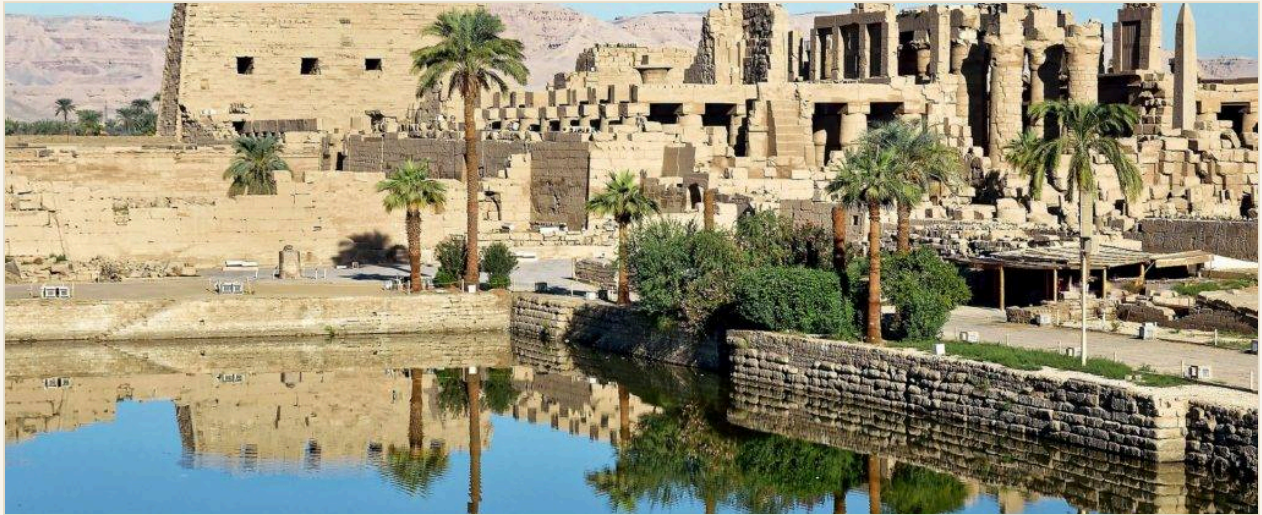
A magical portal is a point of concentrated power where the boundary between the ordinary and the divine world grows thin. Egyptian sacred sites identify several factors, sometimes stated outright, sometimes simply built in, that create or strengthen such a portal: water, magnetism, alignment, orientation, sacred geometry, sacred measure, and, running beneath all of the others, intention itself, the one factor every other technique amplifies but none can replace.

The remaining chapters in this part take each of these in turn, but hold that last point above the rest of them: a perfectly aligned, perfectly proportioned space achieves nothing on its own. It is a tool for concentrating intention, not a substitute for it.

WORDS, SYMBOLS & TOOLS
CHAPTER NINETEEN

Working the Water Portal

The human body is roughly two-thirds water; so, in effect, is the surface of the earth. Water carries subtle influence and attention with unusual ease, which is exactly why every Egyptian temple maintained a genuine sacred lake, fed by groundwater from the Nile, used each dawn by the resident priesthood for purification before any rite began.



The sacred lake at Karnak, still filled with water today

- 1 **Sit With Water Nearby**
A bowl, a stream, any body of water you can sit beside or hold in front of you.
- 2 **Direct Your Attention**
Intend that the water carry your attention and intention outward. Energy follows intention; water is unusually easy to influence this way.
- 3 **Call It Forth**
If working with a specific need, ask directly, for instance asking any local streams or water sources to flow toward you and your working, carrying what you need with them.
- 4 **Use the Water**
Drink it, wash with it, or sprinkle it around your space, exactly as the Ceremony of Purification in Part Four instructs.

WORDS, SYMBOLS & TOOLS
CHAPTER TWENTY

Ley Lines and the Lines of Power

Beyond individual temples, many practitioners work with lines of subtle power said to cross the whole landscape: ley lines, dragon lines, serpent lines, understood as male and female currents of energy that can be traced and dowsed across entire countries. The Michael and Mary lines, running from St Michael's Mount and the Isle of Skellig in the west to Megiddo, Armageddon, in Israel, are among the best known examples, said to cross and recross each other at significant sites the length of their path.

A NOTE ON SOURCES

Ley lines are a twentieth-century British concept, coined by Alfred Watkins in 1921, with no ancient Egyptian textual counterpart. Treat this material as a live, debated framework many serious practitioners use and find genuinely effective, not as settled ancient doctrine. What is not in question is that Egyptian temple builders paid very close attention to siting, alignment, and orientation, which the next chapter covers on firmer historical ground.

WORDS, SYMBOLS & TOOLS
CHAPTER TWENTY-ONE

Alignment, Measure and the Architecture of Power

Egyptian sacred architecture pursued alignment with real rigour: to the four cardinal points, to sub-angles with their own meaning, to the rising of particular stars, and to the sunrise at the solstices and equinoxes. An entrance oriented to the summer solstice channels Ra's power at its yearly maximum; an entrance aligned to the equinox balances masculine and feminine solar energies in equal measure; an alignment to the heliacal rising of Sirius opens toward Isis and the renewal of the year.



The pyramids of Giza

The Great Pyramid's sides are aligned to true north within a small fraction of a degree, done without a compass, which would not exist in Egypt for another two thousand years, most likely through careful observation of two circumpolar stars and bisecting the angle between their rising and setting positions. It is careful, patient surveying carried out with real skill, and it is worth understanding on those terms.



A royal cubit rod, the Egyptians' standard unit of sacred measure

Egyptian builders also worked with a well-documented official unit, the royal cubit, roughly 52.4 centimetres, divided into seven palms of four digits each, applied with real consistency across temple and pyramid construction. You will sometimes meet claims that a universal “megalithic yard” of 2.72 feet, identified by the engineer Alexander Thom from British stone circles, is encoded in the Great Pyramid and links sacred sites worldwide. This sits at the edge of accepted archaeology and is worth treating as a live hypothesis rather than settled fact, alongside the well-attested cubit above.

For your own working space: use a compass to find true cardinal points at your own location, and look up the actual solstice and equinox sunrise directions for your latitude before fixing a permanent altar orientation. You do not need Egypt's monumental scale to use the same principle.

WORDS, SYMBOLS & TOOLS

CHAPTER TWENTY-TWO

Sound, Karnak and the Living Temple

Egyptian temples were built to be heard as much as seen. Different chambers used different geometry, spacing, and stone to produce different tones, harmonics and frequencies, and stone itself was treated as gendered, with male and female stones understood to carry different properties. The King's Chamber in the Great Pyramid, built almost entirely of granite, is well known for the strong, layered resonance it produces when someone chants inside it, an effect you can still hear for yourself on a visit; what exactly that resonance does to the body is it is worth experiencing directly rather than assuming a precise mechanism.



The Great Hypostyle Hall at Karnak, its 134 columns carved with reliefs of the gods

Karnak itself, ancient Ipet-Isut, is the largest religious complex ever built, construction beginning around 2055 BCE and continuing for over two thousand years without real interruption. Its proportions are said to encode the human body, understood as the Temple of Man, so that walking from outer pylon to inner sanctuary is itself a journey of progressive initiation. Every summer solstice, sunrise light travels the full length of the temple to strike the inner sanctuary directly, an alignment refined deliberately over many generations of building rather than achieved by accident.

FOR YOUR OWN PRACTICE

You do not need Karnak's scale to use its principle. Choose or build a working space, even a single room or altar corner, with real attention to what sound does inside it, what direction it faces, and what light reaches it at which times of year. Treat these as active tools, the way the Egyptians did, not as atmosphere.

THE CORE RITES

CHAPTER TWENTY-THREE

The Gathering of the Heka

This is an opening invocation, spoken to gather and centre magical power in yourself before any working begins. Use it at the very start of any rite in this manual where you want to establish your own authority to work before you call on any other power. Speak the transliteration aloud first if you can manage the sounds, then the English, or use the English alone; both carry the same working intention.

Nuk tem-kheperu kheru tesef her hra mut-f. Ertau unsu en amiu Nu, behennu en amiu Djat. Ask tent na heka pen neter, kheru sen entef kheru-sen, betenu er thesem, khak er set. A anen makhent en Ra. Rut aq-k em mehit em khent-ek se-mesert em neter-khert. Ask tem-na heka pen em bu neb enti-f, kheru sen entef kheru-sen, betenu er thesem, khak er set. Arit kheperu em ertu mut em qemam-tu neteru em sekeru. Arta-du entu mut seref en neteru. Ask erta-na heka apen kheru enti-f betenu er thesem, khak er set.

In English: “I am the uncreated god, before whom the dwellers in chaos are dogs, their chiefs merely wolves. I gather the power from every place, from every person, faster than night itself. Hail to him in the heavens, who is strong even before the terror of the darkness. He gathers the power from every place, from every person, faster than light itself. He restores the giver of life; he creates the gods from silence alone and comforts them. He bestows upon me this power, from every place, faster than the shadows that follow the light.”

WORKING NOTE

You are not asking permission to gather this power. You are claiming your own standing, as Heka's own current runs through you as much as through any priest of the temple, before the working itself begins.

THE CORE RITES

CHAPTER TWENTY-FOUR

The Ceremony of Purification

Use this rite to cleanse and prepare yourself before any deeper working in this manual. It moves you through washing, breath, and light, and ends by putting you into the light trance state every other rite in this manual assumes you can reach.

1 Prepare the Water

Dissolve a little bicarbonate of soda in fresh, clean water.

2 Face East

Walk five paces forward from where you intend to sit or stand, and draw a circle of protection around your working space, tracing it four times.

3 Wash and Speak

Wash your hands and face in the water, then say aloud: “Oh great and mighty Ausar, take from me all that is unclean. Open mine eyes that I may see thy vision, glorious. Open my mouth that my words may be heard. Cleanse my ear that I might hear thy holy utterances. Oh great and mighty Ausar, who travels in the Boat of Millions of Years, let me be cleansed here, as I was once, in the holy waters of the Nile.”

4 See Thoth

See Thoth appear before you, god of the moon and of magic. See him take a shadow of yourself and carry it down to Ausar in the underworld, so that what is unclean in you is met and answered there.

5 Breathe Fourfold

Take a fourfold breath: in for four, hold for four, out for four, hold for four. Repeat this until you feel settled.

6 Grow Tall

Imagine yourself growing as tall as the heavens, until your head touches the blue water of the Vault of Heaven far above you. See Ra in his solar barge crossing that sky.

7 Speak as Nu

Say: "I am Nu. I draw air, sustenance and light from the holy presence, from he who traverses the world in his fiery barge, from the utmost limits of heaven, to the depths of Geb below, to the outer limits of our Lady of the Stars. May the purity of the breath of Ra find its place within me."

8 Receive the Light

See Ra extend a ray of light toward you, and breathe that light into every part of your being. Say: "By this light my body is purified. By this light, so too my Ka, my Ba, my Akh; all my bodies now shine bright with the light of the Lord God Ra."

9 Open

Say: "My mouth is open. I see with mine own eyes." Let yourself settle into trance, and remain there for whatever working follows.

THE CORE RITES
CHAPTER TWENTY-FIVE

Opening the Quarters

Almost every deeper rite in this manual, including the Invocation of Isis in Part Five, begins by opening the four quarters. Learn this technique properly here, because later chapters assume you know it and will not repeat the full instruction each time.

The pattern is always the same: you call a guardian god into each direction, paired always with the Son of Horus who already rules that direction and element, from the table given earlier in this manual. Which greater god you call at each quarter can change depending on the working; the four given below are the ones used for the Invocation of Isis, and are a safe default for general use.

1 Face East

Trace a circle in the air before you and say: "I open the double doors of the East, the Gate of the Rising Sun, and invite Horus, the Hawk of the Sun, to guide and guard this place of working. At his side stands Duamutef, ruler of the element of Air. The Gate of the East is open."

2 Face South

Turn to the South, tracing a circle from the East with your finger, and say: "I open the double doors of the South and invite Sekhmet, lion-headed one, Lady of Fire and Flaming Eye of Ra, great one of might and light, to guide us through the darkness to the dawn. At her side stands Imsety, ruler of the element of Fire. The Gate of the South is open."

3 Face West

Turn to the West, tracing a circle from the South, and say: "I open the double doors of the West and invite Isis, Queen of Heaven and Great One of Magic, mother of Horus, sister-wife of Osiris, mother of us all, to hold us under her perfect wings that we may be set free. At her side stands Qebehsenuf, ruler of the element of Water. The Gate of the West is open."

4 Face North

Turn to the North, tracing a circle from the West, and say: "I open the double doors of the North and invite Osiris, great risen one, holy green god of rejuvenation and resurrection, to lead us through the Duat to eternal life beyond. At his side stands Hapi, ruler of the element of Earth. The Gate of the North is open."

5 Seal the Circle

Return to face East, and say: “For about me shines the body of Nuit, and below me the ground of Geb, and in the centre abides the great hidden god.”

CHANGING THE GUARDIANS

For a working with different gods, substitute whichever deity you are calling at the appropriate quarter, keeping the paired Son of Horus fixed. The Anubis-led purification rite in this manual, for instance, calls Anubis at the South in place of Sekhmet. Never leave a quarter unguarded; if you are not calling a specific god at one direction, use the guardian given here as the default.

THE CORE RITES

CHAPTER TWENTY-SIX

Closing the Quarters

Never end a working by simply standing up and walking away. Every quarter you opened must be thanked and released in turn, in the same order you opened them, or you leave your working space, and yourself, open.

1 Face East

“Horus, Hawk of the Sun, and Duamutef, ruler of the element of Air, I thank you for your presence here in this rite. I bid you return to your own time and place in peace, and with the blessings of humankind. The Gate of the East is now closed.”

2 Face South

“You who walk in both the light and the darkness without fear, and Imsety, ruler of the element of Fire, I thank you for your presence here in this rite. I bid you return to your own time and place in peace, and with the blessings of humankind. The Gate of the South is now closed.”

3 Face West

“Lady of the West, and Qebehsenuef, ruler of the element of Water, I thank you for your presence here in this rite. I bid you return to your own time and place in peace, and with the blessings of humankind. The Gate of the West is now closed.”

4 Face North

“Comforter of the sick, and Hapi, ruler of the element of Earth, I thank you for your presence here in this rite. I bid you return to your own time and place in peace, and with the blessings of humankind. The Gate of the North is now closed.”

5 Finish

Face East once more and say: “Our work is complete. Let us put the altar light at rest and return to the world of man.”

WORKING NOTE

Address each guardian by whichever name you actually called at that quarter when you opened; the titles above are placeholders. What matters is that all four are thanked by name and formally released before you leave your working space.

THE CORE RITES
CHAPTER TWENTY-SEVEN

The Ritual of the Four Balls: A Working of Protection

This working was performed in the temple of Osiris at Abydos to protect his corpse from Set, and translates directly into protection for your own temple, home, or working space. Four lion-headed goddesses, each an aspect of Ra's own protective power, are called to stand guard at the four directions.

DIRECTION	GUARDIAN
South	Wadjet
North	Sekhmet
East	Bastet
West	Sekhemet

1 **Prepare Four Balls**

Take four small balls of clay, dough, or any workable material. As you shape each one, hold in mind the guardian and direction it belongs to, and, if you can, mark or name it for that goddess.

2 **Cast Each Ball**

Standing at the centre of your space, throw or place each ball toward its own direction in turn, South, North, East, then West, saying as you do: "[Goddess's name], guard this place in my name as you guarded the body of Ausar at Abydos."

3 **Leave Them**

Leave the four balls in place for as long as you want the protection to hold, traditionally renewed each day for ongoing protection of a temple or shrine.

WORKING NOTE

This is a genuinely simple working, and its strength lies exactly in that simplicity: four humble, physical objects, placed with clear intention, standing in for four of the fiercest protective powers in the whole tradition.

WORKING WITH THE GODS
CHAPTER TWENTY-EIGHT

Isis: Mistress of Magic

The name Isis, or Aset, means The Throne, and she is shown as a beautiful woman wearing a throne on her head as a crown. In later periods she also takes on the horned sun disk of Hathor, whose role she largely absorbed, and she is often shown winged, or kneeling on the hieroglyph for gold, a sign linked to her through its funerary use.

She became associated with the Moon by the New Kingdom, but her older and deeper link is stellar, to Sothis, the star we call Sirius. She is the protective mother and loyal wife of Osiris, but do not stop at that description; she is also the Mistress of Magic, having won Ra's own true name from him by trickery, and with her sister Nephthys she stands close to the dead, present in the underworld beside her husband and brother.



The Metternich Stela, a healing cippus inscribed with spells of Isis against poison and the bites of venomous creatures

NAMES OF POWER

Lou Loulou, Bathanthar, Tharesibath, Ather-Neklesich, Ather-Nebouni, Eichomo Chomothi, Sothis, Soueri, Bubastis, Eurelibat, Weret Hekau, Nebountos, Ouri, Aie Eoa Oai. Vibrate these names slowly, one at a time, when you want to draw close to Isis directly, outside of any full rite.

The rite below, the Invocation of Isis, is a healing working, built to channel her power toward a named person in need. It uses the full quarter-opening and closing given in Chapters Twenty-Five and Twenty-Six; do not skip ahead to the middle of this rite without opening your temple properly first.

1 Set the Altar

A small altar at the centre of the room, dressed in blue with a white top cloth, and a blue centre light. Place an image or statue of Isis on the altar, with incense, salt, and water.

2 Seal the Door

Before anything else, say: "Guardian, please seal the door of the temple to the profane, with the sign of the Jackal Lord, Anubis, Walker between the Worlds and Steersman of the Boat of Millions of Years." State your purpose plainly: "Our task this day is to invoke the energy of our beloved Goddess Isis, and through her assist in the healing of ____."

3 Cleanse with Salt and Water

Sprinkle salt into the water, trace the sign of the ankh enclosed in a circle over the mixture, and say: "With the Light of Ra shining through me, I consecrate this holy water and salt in the name of Ra, the most Holy one." Carry it round the temple, North, East, South, West, sprinkling as you go, saying: "With this consecrated mixture I cast away all that is unclean. May the light of Ra cleanse and hallow this place and make it fit to serve as a temple of the Mysteries."

4 Cleanse with Fire

Take up incense and waft it through each quarter in turn, saying: "With the Fire of Ra, personified by Sekhmet, I cleanse this place for the Gods. May the Power of the Lady of Fire cleanse and hallow this place and make it a fit dwelling place for the Gods of Khem."

5 Open the Quarters

Open East, South, West, and North exactly as given in Chapter Twenty-Five, calling Horus, Sekhmet, Isis, and Osiris. Then travel, in trance or true astral working, to the Temple of the Mysteries of Egypt, following whatever inner journey serves you best to arrive there.

6 Call Isis

Standing before the altar in the West, facing East, raise your arms and say: "Oh Isis, daughter of Nuit, Mistress of Magic, Star of oceans deep. You are the healer of souls, eternal mother to the children of the Earth, perfection of womanhood. Each time a child is loved, nurtured and healed we see your guiding hand of love and light. Eternal mother, come to us now, come join your beloved sister Nephthys, and assist us as you did in your own time in the land of Khem."

7 Chant Her Praise

Facing her image, chant: "Hekau, Hekau, Hail Isis, Hail Isis, we Hail Isis. Hekau, Hekau, Hail Isis, Beloved of Atum. Hail the mother and the guide, Hail Isis, we Hail Isis. Dark and golden twin Isis, with thee we would bide. Accept the praise we offer here, Hail Isis, we Hail Isis. Let thy Godhead now appear, O Thou of infinite Time."

8 Direct the Healing

Say: "Holy Isis, you, whose sacred presence in this temple we have commanded, we request and desire your assistance in the healing of _____. Powered with the force of our intention, send your divine healing energy to speed and make complete the recovery of _____." Hold the person in mind, following your thought and directing it toward her.

9 Give Thanks and Release

When the working feels complete, say: "Isis, Mistress of Magic, we give thanks to you for your presence here in this rite. I bless you and bid you farewell until the next time. Go in peace and return to your own place and time." Approach the altar, place your hands on it, and draw up whatever portion of the energy is due to you before returning to your seat.

10 Return and Close

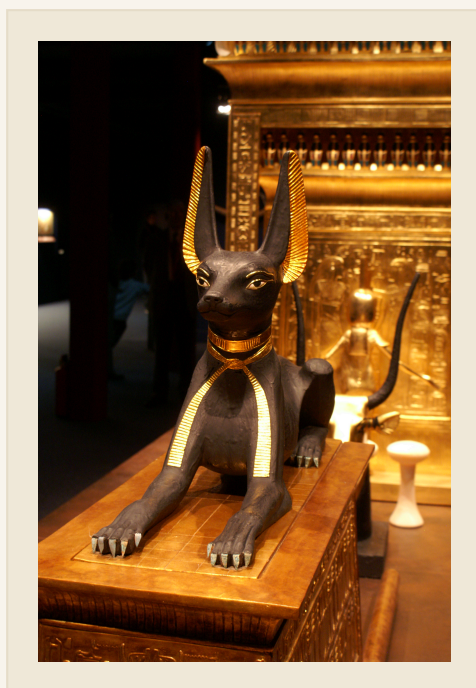
Return from the astral temple to your own time and place, then close the quarters exactly as given in Chapter Twenty-Six.

SPELLS AND SONGS OF ISIS

A chant of invocation, given here in transliteration: "Nas i Aset, me khet en Aset, me unfu em ta Aset, ma an rat Aset, me unfu en ma het en ab heka shenaton, heri ba en Aset, ma khet on Aset, me khet en Maat Aset, me khet en Aset." And a healing spell against poison, spoken over Ra: "In the name of great Isis, may this poison depart from Ra. Oh eye of Horus, go hence from the God and shine outside his mouth. It is Isis who makes fall the poison upon the Earth. Ra lives and the poison dies. The poison dies and Ra lives." A further healing formula, again in transliteration: "Au sau nau sut tui ent nekek ur, rut es, rut ar, enksh es, enksh ar, seset es nivu, seset ar nivu, seset ar aru, unu tefet ar sep sen, ksher kshu em kshenu kekui er kshat nepfer em neter."

Anubis: Guardian of the Threshold

Anubis, or Anup, means Royal Child, a name that later texts tie to the myth of his birth from the union of Nephthys and Osiris. Earlier tradition instead makes him the child of Bastet, or of the cow goddess Hesat. He is shown as a jackal or wild dog-headed man, or as a reclining black jackal, and he is the great protector god, guiding the soul through the underworld, and Lord of embalming, which ties him closely to incense and perfumery.



A shrine figure of Anubis, guardian of the threshold between the worlds

By the New Kingdom he commands legions of protective spirits and can be appealed to against curses and negative magic; he also punishes those who violate tombs or offend the gods. He was originally the ruler of the underworld before that role passed to Osiris, and his standing was never really diminished by the change, hence titles like Hery Seshta, Master of Secrets, and Wer-Hekau, Mighty One of Magic. Sirius was sacred to him as well as to Isis, and it has been suggested Sirius B belongs to Anubis, Sirius A to Isis.

HIS FULL CALLING

“The Jackal Lord, Anubis, Walker between the Worlds and Steersman of the Boat of Millions of Years.” This is his opening title in the Invocation of Isis, and it is the one to use whenever you need him specifically as guardian of a doorway, physical or inner, rather than in his general role at the South in an opened temple.

Use the working below any time you are about to cross a threshold you cannot fully see the other side of: before a pathworking into the Duat, before deep shadow work, before entering any space you know holds real risk as well as real value.

1 Stand at the Door

Physically stand at the threshold you are about to cross, whether that is your temple door, the edge of your working space, or simply the moment before you close your eyes to begin an inner journey.

2 Call Him by His Full Title

Say aloud: “Jackal Lord, Anubis, Walker between the Worlds and Steersman of the Boat of Millions of Years, seal this door to the profane, and stand with me as I cross it.”

3 State Your Purpose

Name simply and honestly what you are about to do and why, exactly as you would state your purpose to any guardian before asking to pass. Anubis punishes those who cross thresholds carelessly; he does not stand in the way of those who cross them with honesty.

4 Cross

Step over the threshold, or close your eyes and begin your journey, trusting that he walks the boundary with you, in both the light and the darkness, without fear.

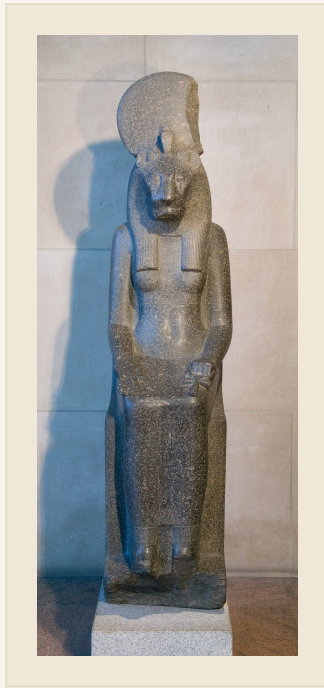
5 Thank Him on Return

When you come back, whether physically or from an inner journey, pause at the same threshold and say: “Jackal Lord, I thank you for your guidance between the worlds. The door is sealed behind me. Go in peace.”

WORKING WITH THE GODS
CHAPTER THIRTY

Sekhmet: The Lady of Fire

Sekhmet, or Sakhmet, means powerful female, and she is exactly that: the personification of the heat of the midday sun, her father Ra's own fire, and the destroyer of demons and pestilence. She is shown as a lioness-headed woman wearing a wig and solar disk, a uraeus serpent rising at her brow, and she was believed to ride to war in the Pharaoh's own chariot, ensuring Egypt's victory in battle.



A statue of Sekhmet, lioness-headed daughter of Ra

She breathes fire to burn Egypt's enemies, and the hot desert winds were called her breath. If a person was burned, offerings were made to appease her for whatever had upset her. She is the Lady of the Red Linen, a title she shares with Hathor, with whom she is so closely linked that the two are sometimes read as two faces of one goddess. Ruby is her sacred stone, its hardness and colour both fitting her nature, and her Seven Arrows bring misfortune, often as disease, to those who anger Ra, though the same arrows ward off the evil eye when turned to protective use. She is also the Mistress of Life, and her priests were counted among Egypt's most noted healers.

The pathworking below takes you to meet her directly, in the aspect that matters most for your own inner work: The one whose fire, once faced honestly, becomes the fire that heals.

SEKHMET PATHWORKING

Close your eyes and settle into a steady, fourfold breath. See yourself standing at the edge of a desert at midday, the sun directly overhead, the heat pressing down on you with real weight. Ahead of you, half seen in the shimmer of the heat itself, stands a lioness-headed woman, solar disk burning above her brow, the uraeus rising at her forehead. This is Sekhmet, Lady of Fire, Flaming Eye of Ra. Do not look away from her heat. Walk toward her, and as you do, feel the sun's full force bearing down, as a fire that burns away whatever in you is already dead weight, whatever illness, resentment, or fear you have been carrying that no longer serves you. Say to her: "Sekhmet, Lady of the Red Linen, Mistress of Life, I come before your fire and ask you to burn in me only what needs to be burned." See her raise one hand, and feel a wave of heat pass through your whole body, from the crown of your head to the soles of your feet. Where it passes, feel whatever was sick or stagnant in you scorched clean, exactly as the desert wind that carries her breath scours the sand itself. This may be uncomfortable. Let it be uncomfortable. Sekhmet's healing is it is thorough. When the heat passes, see her expression change, the destroyer settling into the healer, and know that her priests, in ancient Egypt, were among the finest physicians of their age precisely because they had learned to work with this same fire rather than fear it. Ask her, if you have a specific working still to do, a protection to set or an illness to address, and let her answer come to you in whatever form it takes, image, word, or simple certainty. When you are ready, thank her: "Sekhmet, Mistress of Life, I thank you for your fire. Go in peace, and take with you what no longer serves." Watch her recede back into the shimmer of the heat, and let the desert fade. Return Pathworking: feel the ground beneath your own body again, take three slow breaths, and open your eyes.

WORKING WITH THE GODS
CHAPTER THIRTY-ONE

Osiris: Lord of the Underworld

The original meaning of Osiris, or Asar, is lost, though it may derive from Useru, Mighty One. He is shown mummified, carrying the crook and flail, with black or green skin, and wears the Atef crown, the conical white crown of Upper Egypt framed with tall red plumes representing Busiris, the centre of his worship, and ram's horns showing his virility.



A corn mummy, a vegetation effigy of Osiris made for the annual Khoiak festival

Orion was sacred to him, and the pyramids were aligned to it; seven was his sacred number, the number of days he spent in his mother Nuit's womb, and multiples of seven recur around him, his body cut into fourteen parts, the forty-two gates of the Underworld. He began as a vegetation god, giving man corn, the ability to cultivate it, and wine, and the black Nile mud, vital to the land's fertility, stood for him as the fertile god in his union with Isis as the Nile's own flowing waters. After his death, and the loss of his fertility, he becomes Lord of the Underworld, no longer fertile himself but holding a role of far greater weight.

He carries the crook in his left hand, a symbol of divine authority and his link to humanity as their shepherd, receiving them into his kingdom after death, and the flail in his right, a symbol of kingship carried by every Pharaoh who identified with him. A variant of this arm position, crossed at the chest, survives into modern magic as the Osiris position, used whenever a working calls for the stance of one who has already died and been reborn.

The Djed pillar is his backbone, and the hieroglyph for Djed means stability. It may originally have been a pillar of corn sheaves or reeds before it came to represent his spine, and it may also have stood as an axis mundi, uniting earth and sky. The working below, the raising of the Djed, moves power up through eight centres of your own body, treated as the vertebrae of that same pillar, ending in the Pharaonic ceremony that gave his rite its name: the raising of the pillar itself, and with it, his rebirth.

1 State Intention

Say: "I will raise the Pillar of Djed, the backbone of my Beloved, that He may be reborn."

2

Crown

See a closed white lotus as a spinning ball of white light above your head. Vibrate the name PEREMU six times until it opens and spins. Then vibrate AHA-SEKHET six times.

3

Third Eye

Vibrate METRUI six times until a closed white lotus at your third eye opens and spins. Then vibrate TERI-ASI six times.

4

Back of the Head

Vibrate MATHENU until a closed white lotus at the back of your head opens and spins. Then vibrate PAN-ARI six times.

5

Throat

Vibrate MENU, then open the centre with HEQ NETERU.

6

Heart

Vibrate NEB ER TCHER at the heart, then open it with NEB AATTI.

7

Solar Plexus

Vibrate SEKHEN KHAIBIT at the solar plexus, then open it with TCHAMUTI.

8

Groin

Vibrate AMON at the groin, then open it with AM SEKHET.

9

Base of the Spine

Vibrate HETEP TA at the base of the spine, then open it with SEKHTI.

10

Raise the Pillar

Say: "Rise!" Breathe in green light through the soles of your feet, drawing it up through every centre you have just opened, all the way to the crown. Breathe out, and radiate that light outward from your whole body. Repeat this breath ten times.

WORKING NOTE

This working stands on its own as a raising of personal power, but it is also, quite literally, the myth it enacts: Osiris's scattered body made whole again, his spine raised, life restored to what was cut apart. Do not rush the vibrations; each centre should be felt to open before you move to the next.

WORKING WITH THE GODS**CHAPTER THIRTY-TWO****Thoth: Lord of the Sacred Word**

Djehuty, Thoth, means Leader. He is the god of magic and writing, and gave mankind many gifts, beer, bread, and writing among them. He is most often shown as an ibis-headed man, and sometimes as an ibis outright, or as a baboon, the Ape of Thoth, and in some tellings he creates the universe through speech alone.



A bronze figure of Thoth in his ibis-headed form

Originally a moon god, he is noted above all for truth and integrity, hence the old saying that a person had lived their life straight and true like Thoth. He is patron of scribes, who poured a libation from the water pot they dipped their pens in at the start of each working day, and silver, the lunar metal, belongs to him, as does emerald, which he is said to have given mankind. Different tellings have him born from the lips of Ra, or from the forehead of Set after Set swallowed some of Horus's semen.

This pathworking takes you to the Library beneath the Sphinx, Thoth's own hidden hall of records. Treat it as you would any deep pathworking: do not rush the descent, and do not be troubled if what you find inside is different from what you expected.

THOTH PATHWORKING TO THE LIBRARY BENEATH THE SPHINX

Close your eyes, settle your breath, and see yourself standing before the Great Sphinx at Giza in the stillness before dawn. The stars are still out above you. Approach the great stone paws, and see, between them, a doorway that is not visible in the daylit world, a narrow stair leading down into the rock beneath the Sphinx's own body. Descend. Count your steps if it steadies you, and as you go, feel the air change, growing cooler and stiller, carrying the faint scent of old papyrus and dry stone. At the foot of the stair, a long hall opens before you, lined floor to ceiling with shelves, scroll-niches, and tablets in a script you may or may not be able to read. This is the Library beneath the Sphinx. At the centre of the hall stands an ibis-headed figure, tall, still, holding a reed pen and a palette. This is Thoth. Approach him and say: "Djehuty, Lord of the Sacred Word, patron of scribes, who lived his life straight and true, I come to your library seeking what I need to know." Ask him your question, whatever it is you came here to learn, whether about a working, a piece of your own path, or a piece of knowledge you have been seeking elsewhere without success. Watch what he does in answer: he may hand you a scroll, gesture toward a particular shelf, speak a single word, or simply look at you until an answer forms in your own mind. Accept whatever comes, even if it is not what you expected, and do not press him for more than he offers. When the exchange feels complete, bow to him and say: "Djehuty, I thank you for what you have shown me here. I will carry it honestly, as you carry truth yourself." Turn from him, walk back down the long hall, and climb the stair back up toward the doorway between the Sphinx's paws. Return Pathworking: step back out into the stillness before dawn, feel the doorway close behind you, and let the Sphinx and the desert fade. Take three slow breaths, feel your own body in your own chair, and open your eyes. Write down what you were shown before it fades, exactly as a scribe of Thoth would.

FURTHER READING

BIBLIOGRAPHY

Bibliography and Further Reading

The following texts represent a strong foundation for serious study of Egyptian magick, ranging from primary source translations to academic scholarship and practical, ritual-focused works.

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- **The Ancient Egyptian Pyramid Texts / The Ancient Egyptian Coffin Texts**, R.O. Faulkner. 1969 / 1973-78. The standard scholarly translations.
- **The Complete Gods and Goddesses of Ancient Egypt**, Richard H. Wilkinson. 2003. The best single reference on the Neteru.
- **The Sacred Magic of Ancient Egypt**, Rosemary Clark. 2003. Practical, ritual-focused, a source informing several of the workings in this book.
- **Invoking the Egyptian Gods / Pathworking the Egyptian Gods**, Judith Page. 2011 / 2013. A useful companion for further invocations and pathworkings.
- **The Goddess Sekhmet: Psycho-Spiritual Exercises of the Fifth Way**, Robert Masters. 1991. The deepest available source on embodied Sekhmet work.
- **Practical Egyptian Magic**, Murry Hope. 1984. An early modern practical manual, read critically.
- **Temple of the Cosmos**, Jeremy Naydler. 1996. The strongest single study of ancient Egyptian ritual consciousness.

A NOTE ON SOURCES

This material draws on primary Egyptian texts and mainstream Egyptology alongside the modern practical magical literature built on that scholarship. Students are encouraged to bring questions about specific techniques or correspondences into class discussion.